Why Most AI Edits Look Cheap (3 Fixes)

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 25, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/MJ8Pp5xcd04 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter explains three specific techniques he uses so Claude-edited videos look polished rather than cheap: real B-roll footage, self-review by the AI before delivery, and automatic sound design.

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🚫 Fix 1: No Stock Footage — Use Real Clips 0:00

- The core problem with most AI edits is relying on generic stock footage for B-roll
  - Stock footage signals low production value and feels disconnected from the content
- The fix: supply Claude with **real footage** — your own clips, screenshots, and client testimonials — to use as B-roll
  - Example: when Brandon mentions "Quinton hit $35,000 in one month as an online trainer," Quinton's actual clip plays
  - Example: when he mentions helping "Jyn make over $500,000 her first year as an online trainer," her clip plays automatically
- Practical payoff: Brandon says he never has to open Cap Cut, Final Cut, or Adobe Premiere

🔍 Fix 2: Make Claude Check Its Own Work First 0:22

- Instruct Claude to self-review the full edit *before* showing it to you
- The self-review checklist Claude runs through:
  - Watch the whole reel back
  - Confirm his face is never covered up by captions or graphics
  - Verify captions are on time / properly synced
  - Confirm all stumbles and mistakes have been edited out
- The prompt is simple: **"Watch it back before you show it to me"**

🔊 Fix 3: Full Sound Design Handled by AI 0:46

- Claude also handles all sound design as part of the edit — not just cuts and captions
- Specific elements it adds:
  - Sound effects
  - Swooshes
  - Click sounds (e.g., when typing is shown on screen)
  - Various small ambient/transitional details
- These elements are subtle — viewers may not consciously notice them, but "something would feel off if it wasn't there"
- Brandon frames these small sonic details as what truly elevates an edit from amateur to high quality